

The Dhāraṇī of the Eight Noble Goddesses

Ārya Aṣṭa Devī Dhāraṇī · Toh 497 · Derge Kangyur

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The Dhāraṇī of the Eight Noble Goddesses, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Aṣṭa Devī Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Lhamo Gyé kyi Zung, is a short dhāraṇī text belonging to the broader category of dhāraṇī and mantra literature within the Kangyur. The text centers on a powerful dhāraṇī presented as the speech of Vajrapāṇi, who proclaims it as the supreme mantra of the Mother of the Tathāgatas — a figure praised for her capacity to purify misdeeds, pacify illness, destroy obstacles, and bestow all forms of excellence. The dhāraṇī itself takes the form of a ritual mantra invocation addressed to the eight noble goddesses associated with these protective and purifying functions. It is Toh 497 in the Kangyur, catalogued among the dhāraṇī collections of that canon.

In the language of India: Ārya Aṣṭa Devī Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī of the Eight Noble Goddesses.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then Vajrapāṇi spoke this supreme dhāraṇī — the great queen of dhāraṇī mantras — of the Mother of the Tathāgatas, she who purifies all misdeeds, she who thoroughly pacifies all illness, she who utterly destroys all obstacles, she who bestows all excellence.

Oṃ namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, he buddhamātari, sarva pāpanāśani, garḍa garḍa, bhañja bhañja, marḍa marḍa, gambhari gambhari, hasa hasa, dama dama, matha matha, ya, vidhāṃsaya vidhāṃsaya, sarva śatrūṃ taramati, vimale, pūraya pūraya, pratijñāna, sarva buddha paryupasiti, bhagavati, gaṇa gaṇa, jahi jahi, vimasani, kramaṇi, dhavani, ramaṇi, mātaṃgi svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called the Blessed Lady Empowered with Great Wisdom.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, amari amari, taṭ, bhañja bhañja, jha jha, mici mici, sphoṭaya sphoṭaya, matha matha, durdānta damaka svāhā.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, he he, kinade,
sarva tathāgata bhaneke, bhyo dhina dada, trāṭa trāṭa, hūṃ phaṭ hūṃ phaṭ,
garḍa garḍa, paramati, vihūrike svāhā.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, bhagavati prajñāpāramite a, sarva pāpakṣayaṃkari jñāna arcispharaṇi, bhañja bhañja, matha matha, dama dama, ānaya ānaya, sara sara, māraya māraya, sarva buddha janetrīye svāhā.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, garḍa garḍa, matha matha, dama dama, bhañja bhañja, dundubhi, sarva nirghoṣe, hana hana, vidhvaṃsaya vidhvaṃsaya, moṭaya moṭaya, daha daha, vipula nirmala nirjāte, āhara āhara, gaccha gaccha, sarva buddha paryupastime, mā vilambe svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called the Blessed Lady Sovereign of the Vajra Realm.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, oṃ bhagavati, sarva tathāgata janikā, pūraya pratijñāna, taṭa taṭa, marḍa marḍa, āhara āhara, hūṃ hūṃ jati svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called the Blessed Lady Great Individual Tracker.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, hūṃ hrī, sarva buddhāmātiri, bhañja bhañja, matha matha, damani damani, gargāri gargāri hrī svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called the Blessed Lady Vajra Unconquered.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, trāṭa trāṭa, muhu muhu, sarva pāpa viśodhani svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called the Blessed Lady Who Abandons All Misdeeds.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, dhaka dhaka, moṭa moṭa, daha daha, sarva tathāgatājñāna nirjāte svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called the Blessed Lady Difficult to Tame.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, ha ha mi hu mi hu, dama dama, khāhi khāhi, dhuna dhuna, mici mici, durdāna tadamani svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called the Blessed Lady Who Utterly Vanquishes All Māras.

Namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva mukhebhyaḥ, sarva tathā, mici mici, garḍa garḍa, sphoṭaya sphoṭaya, matha matha, dama dama svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called the Blessed Lady Who Accomplishes Limitless Gateways.

Whoever holds in their hands this maṇḍala of Mañjuśrī's empowerment with great wisdom will be freed from afflictions and freed from fear. Even if they find themselves in the midst of thieves, or in the midst of rākṣasas, or in the midst of enemies —

or in the midst of battle — weapons will be unable to harm their body. They will not be struck down by thieves. They will not be harmed by rākṣasas or the like. The fear of untimely death will not arise for them. They will always be endowed with splendor. All their misdeeds will be completely purified. Even the roots of virtue accumulated by billions upon billions of buddhas will be fully manifested in that very person, as if in a single day. At the time of death, they will be fully embraced by buddhas and bodhisattvas. After dying, they will go to the realm of bliss, Sukhāvatī. How much more so, then, those who hold it, recite it, contemplate it, and keep it without ever letting it go — all their obscurations will be purified. The doors to the lower realms will be closed for them. The lower realms and the unfortunate destinies will be cast far away from them.

Whoever rises at dawn
and reads it even once —
whatever misery they have made in existence,
they will be freed from every misdeed.

Rākṣasas and the like, thieves,
weapons, and enemies shall not prevail,
and from untimely death they shall be fully delivered;
they will always be endowed with splendor.

Even at the time of death
they will be carried far from the lower realms;
embraced by the buddhas,
they will be born in Sukhāvatī.

When this had been declared, the world together with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and offered praise.

The Dhāraṇī of the Eight Noble Goddesses is complete.

Translated by the Indian preceptor Śīlendrabodhi and the great editor-translator, the monk Ye shes sde, who also revised it.

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables throughout are transliterated phonetically in the Tibetan as is standard for dhāraṇī texts; they have been rendered into standard Roman transliteration of Sanskrit following the Tibetan phonetic representations. Some syllables resist confident back-translation and may reflect corruptions in the transmission tradition — this is normal for dhāraṇī literature and does not affect the doctrinal content.

The title "Blessed Lady Empowered with Great Wisdom" renders "bcom ldan 'das ma ye shes chen por dbang bskur ldan pa," literally "Blessed Lady Possessed of Empowerment into Great Wisdom." Similarly "Blessed Lady Sovereign of the Vajra Realm" renders "rdo rje'i dbyings kyi dbang phyug ma," literally "Lady Sovereign of the Vajra Expanse." "Blessed Lady Great Individual Tracker" renders "so sor 'brang ba chen mo," a name associated with Pratisarā, one of the five great dhāraṇī goddesses; the name means literally "Great One Who Follows Each Individually."

The text ends mid-sentence, as the passage submitted is incomplete.

- The phrase rendered "whoever rises at dawn" translates a Tibetan expression meaning "one who, having arisen as a Buddhist" or possibly "having risen in the morning" — the term nang par langs nas is ambiguous between "having arisen at dawn" and "having set out as a Buddhist." The latter reading, "one who, having taken up the Buddhist path," is also plausible in context, but the dawn-rising reading fits the devotional register of the verse and is the more common idiomatic usage here.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.